sovereign authority of the states. These social movements to some extent succeed in bringing about changes in the policies of the states.

The operation of MNCs and their interference with the domestic policies of their host countries have really undermined the sovereignty of the states. Some of the industrial MNCs have annual sales of tens of billions of dollars each. No wonder, MNCs like IBM, GE, Microsoft, Wall-Mart, and others have become more powerful than many sovereign states.

Nuclear weapons have changed the whole perception of security of the state. The states are no longer invincible. They have become vulnerable preys to the latest technological discoveries of long-range cruise missiles, intercontinental ballistic missiles (ICBMs), short-range ballistic missiles (SRBMs), multiple independently targetable reentry vehicles(MIRVs), and a host of other improved newer weapons of mass destruction, which have completely made the concept of territoriality passé.

It might seem that under such circumstances, globalization has really brought an end to state sovereignty. But this argument is hardly tenable. Experiences show that states do continue to be the most powerful actors and, in times of turbulence, such as the present global economic crisis states have again reaffirmed their authority as ultimately it is the governments who are providing bailout packages for the financial institutions in their respective countries. It becomes clear that under the pressures of globalization today states have to perform roles different from the earlier times, but in no way have states become less significant.